

Gaming and social networks

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Social networks and computer games have converged to a point where most games give players a chance to play with others online, and many social networks offer embedded games.

Social network gaming

Many social networks allow their users to play games within their network, and to share their progress with those they are socially connected to. These simple games usually run via Flash animation within the website or app. They tend to feature uncomplicated tasks such as farming or building that take time to develop, and motivate users returning to the site to check on their progress.



Whether in a social media game or app, many games offer players the ability to unlock special abilities or levels. These in-game purchases are called “microtransactions” and are charged to the account holder, who should be aware of this if others are using their devices. Microtransactions can be disabled in all major gaming platforms, usually by looking in the settings or account menus, or you can require a password to be given in order to make an in-app purchase.

Microtransactions

The player can make in-game purchases to increase their ability to play the game: usually to speed time up, or give them special abilities for a set period of time.

Continuous goals

These games feature objectives that get progressively more difficult. The goals are relatively straightforward but it may take time or in-game money to be able to achieve them.

Achievements

Each completed goal is rewarded with some form of prize or feedback, so the player is encouraged to keep playing. There are usually no victory conditions in these games, so this is how the player “wins”.

